Practical 2: Build a Grouped RetailPulse Sales List Report

Related topic: Create List Reports

Objective

Construct a list report, group it meaningfully, format its columns, and add a summarizing footer.

Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the RetailPulse Sales package, and the report saved in Practical 1 (optional starting point).

Step-by-step procedure

Step	Action in Cognos Analytics	What you should see
1	Create a new **List** report on the **RetailPulse Sales** package.	An empty list opens in the authoring workspace.
2	Drag **Region, Store Name, Product Category, Quantity** and **Sales Amount** into the list.	Five columns appear in that order.
3	Select the Region column, click **Group/Ungroup**, then do the same for Store Name.	Region becomes the outer group and Store Name the inner group; repeated values collapse into bands.
4	Select Sales Amount, open **Data format**, choose **Currency** (USD, 2 decimals); right-align Quantity and Sales Amount.	Values display as $1,234.56 and align to the right edge.
5	Select Sales Amount and choose **Summarize > Total** (Calculate > Total) so a footer is added under the column.	A footer row with Total appears for each Store Name group and an overall total at the end.
6	Add a page header containing a text item with the report title and a **Date** item (current date); click **Run**, then **Save**.	Title and today's run date show at the top of every output page.

Sample solution

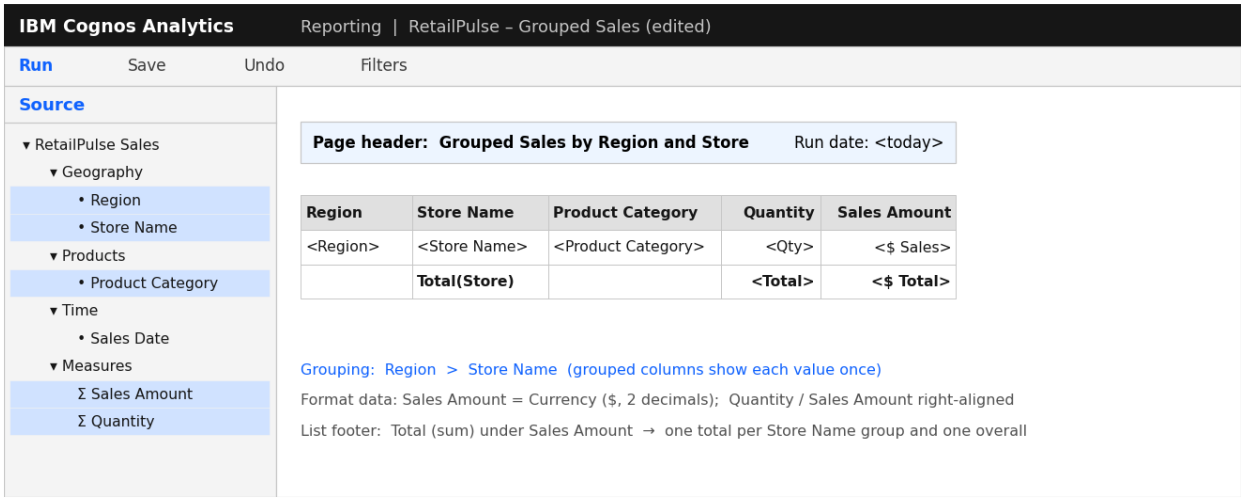


Figure 1. Design view: two-level grouping, currency format, footer total and page header.

Total aggregation used in the footer:

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Total(Sales Amount) → rollup aggregate = Total, scope = group (Store Name) and overall
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Report output (Run HTML) – starts on the next page. The page header repeats on every page.

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
North	Highland Park	Apparel	1,759	$84,643.43
		Electronics	776	$112,211.64
		Grocery	5,161	$72,279.08
		Home & Kitchen	1,212	$75,267.94
		Sports & Outdoors	999	$71,927.19
		Total – Highland Park	**9,907**	**$416,329.28**
	North Plaza	Apparel	1,451	$69,512.90
		Electronics	696	$100,879.10
		Grocery	4,108	$57,377.70
		Home & Kitchen	1,042	$64,884.19
		Sports & Outdoors	861	$61,949.46
		Total – North Plaza	**8,158**	**$354,603.35**
	Northgate Mall	Apparel	1,186	$56,700.41
		Electronics	537	$78,272.55
		Grocery	3,426	$47,923.66
		Home & Kitchen	836	$51,918.95
		Sports & Outdoors	682	$49,093.84
		Total – Northgate Mall	**6,667**	**$283,909.41**
	Total – North region		**24,732**	**$1,054,842.04**
South	Bayview	Apparel	2,025	$97,311.02
		Electronics	924	$134,238.67
		Grocery	5,700	$79,822.87
		Home & Kitchen	1,503	$93,617.86
		Sports & Outdoors	1,240	$89,552.88
		Total – Bayview	**11,392**	**$494,543.30**
	Riverside	Apparel	1,724	$82,552.45
		Electronics	762	$109,974.78
		Grocery	4,859	$68,218.47
		Home & Kitchen	1,236	$76,448.49
		Sports & Outdoors	996	$71,806.12
		Total – Riverside	**9,577**	**$409,000.31**
	Southpoint	Apparel	1,400	$67,110.94
		Electronics	586	$84,889.38
		Grocery	3,792	$53,113.53
		Home & Kitchen	1,003	$62,190.18
		Sports & Outdoors	807	$58,001.88
		Total – Southpoint	**7,588**	**$325,305.91**
	Total – South region		**28,557**	**$1,228,849.52**
East	Eastwood	Apparel	1,536	$73,358.68

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
		Electronics	670	$96,630.81
		Grocery	4,262	$59,549.59
		Home & Kitchen	1,092	$67,785.22
		Sports & Outdoors	889	$63,877.29
		Total – Eastwood	**8,449**	**$361,201.59**
	Harbor Square	Apparel	1,281	$61,260.79
		Electronics	502	$72,990.94
		Grocery	3,598	$50,417.60
		Home & Kitchen	881	$54,923.52
		Sports & Outdoors	797	$57,258.14
		Total – Harbor Square	**7,059**	**$296,850.99**
	Maple Court	Apparel	982	$47,170.55
		Electronics	439	$63,535.30
		Grocery	2,993	$41,893.03
		Home & Kitchen	687	$42,753.07
		Sports & Outdoors	618	$44,552.94
		Total – Maple Court	**5,719**	**$239,904.89**
	Total – East region		**21,227**	**$897,957.47**
West	Pacific Heights	Apparel	2,197	$105,797.40
		Electronics	1,003	$145,305.68
		Grocery	6,284	$87,985.32
		Home & Kitchen	1,614	$100,224.24
		Sports & Outdoors	1,371	$99,098.87
		Total – Pacific Heights	**12,469**	**$538,411.51**
	Sunset Boulevard	Apparel	1,864	$89,710.73
		Electronics	839	$120,907.50
		Grocery	5,250	$73,517.40
		Home & Kitchen	1,362	$84,304.30
		Sports & Outdoors	1,103	$79,508.49
		Total – Sunset Boulevard	**10,418**	**$447,948.42**
	Westfield	Apparel	1,470	$70,574.27
		Electronics	637	$92,149.45
		Grocery	4,143	$58,269.42
		Home & Kitchen	1,112	$69,215.05
		Sports & Outdoors	873	$62,869.73
		Total – Westfield	**8,235**	**$353,077.92**
	Total – West region		**31,122**	**$1,339,437.85**
Total – All regions			**105,638**	**$4,521,086.88**

Verification against the expected outcome

Expected outcome check	Result
Region bands containing nested Store Name bands	**Pass** – 4 regions, 12 stores; repeated values collapsed
Currency formatting and right alignment	**Pass** – Sales Amount shown as $#,###.## and right-aligned
Correct summed total beneath each Store Name group	**Pass** – 12 store totals plus 4 region totals and an overall total
Overall total reconciles	**Pass** – $4,521,086.88 = sum of all rows (105,638 units)
Page header on every page	**Pass** – Title and run date repeat on each output page

Note on screens: the screenshots in this document are Cognos-style renderings produced from a synthetic RetailPulse dataset (12 stores, 4 regions, 5 product categories, 1 Jan–25 Oct 2026). Replace them with live captures from your own Cognos environment if your submission requires real screenshots.